

User Research Findings — Spring Study

Twelve interviews, four diary studies, and a survey of 1,240 users.

This document summarizes the themes that appeared most often.

Theme — Losing Your Place

Nine of twelve participants described losing their place in long documents as their single biggest frustration.

Quote: “I have a 300-page manual. Every time I open it I have to scroll and hunt. I just stopped using it.”

This is our biggest opportunity.

Theme — Too Many Files

Users describe their downloads folder as a junk drawer. They cannot find what they saved.

Quote: "I know I downloaded it. I just do not know where it went."

Folders alone are not enough. Users want to search by what the document is about.

Theme — Reading at Night

Seven of twelve read in bed. Blue light and harsh white backgrounds were mentioned repeatedly.

Quote: "It hurts my eyes. I usually just give up and look at my phone instead."

A warm reading mode is not a nice-to-have. It is table stakes.

Recommendations

One: make resume-reading the center of the experience. Two: add tags and smart search.

Three: ship a sepia and night reading mode.

Four: keep the interface quiet. Users do not want a filing system. They want their document back.